What does your preferred social media say about you?

Vojtech Martinat, Dr. Matthew Edwards
School of Computer Science, University of Bristol

Daily, people spend 10 billion hours on social media [1] in total. The average user engages with 6–7 platforms on average [2]. Understanding how interface design influences user behaviour and experience is increasingly important.

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My goal is to understand the impact that the user interface styles of social media systems have on their users. What insights into personality can be derived from a user's preferred platforms?

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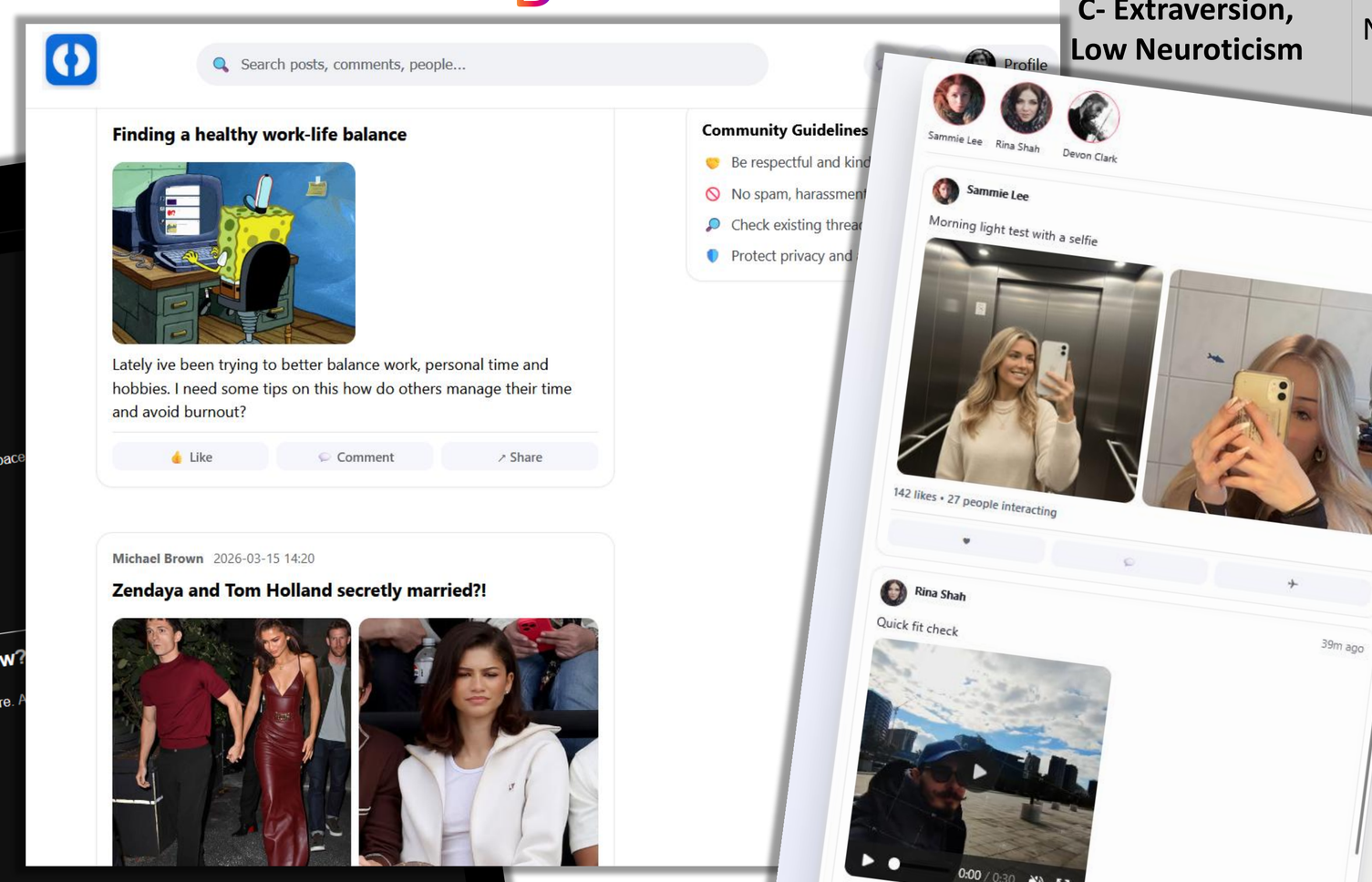
I used existing research to tailor my study to social media. Three mockup interfaces were created to target specific traits.

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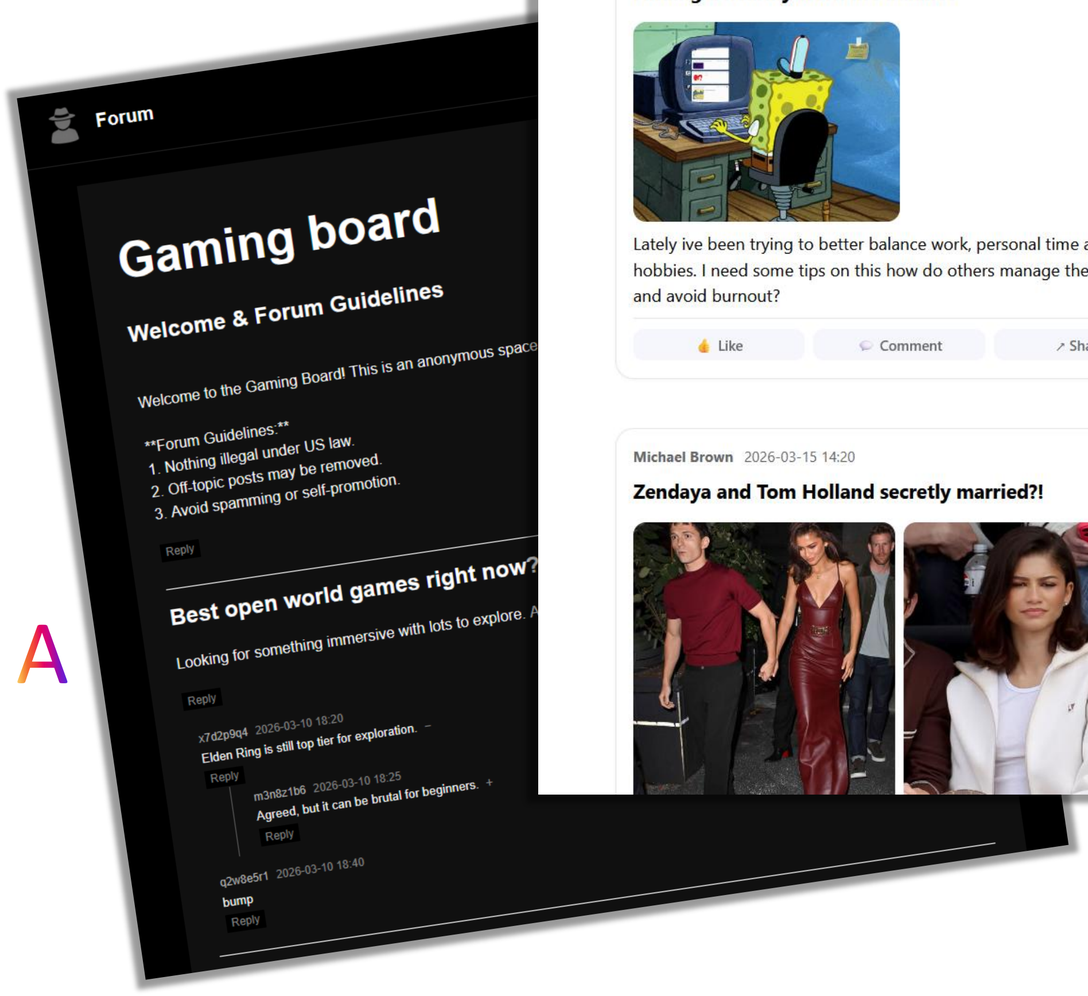
Some personality-aligned design values [3]

Personality Cluster	Friction to Interact	Anonymity & Social Rules
A -Openness, Neuroticism	High – Mandatory CAPTCHA verification	Fully anonymous – Minimal explicit rules
B - Conscientiousness, Agreeableness	Medium – Additional context windows	Identifiable profile – Rules always visible
C- Extraversion, Low Neuroticism	None	Faces on profile images – Explicit content moderation

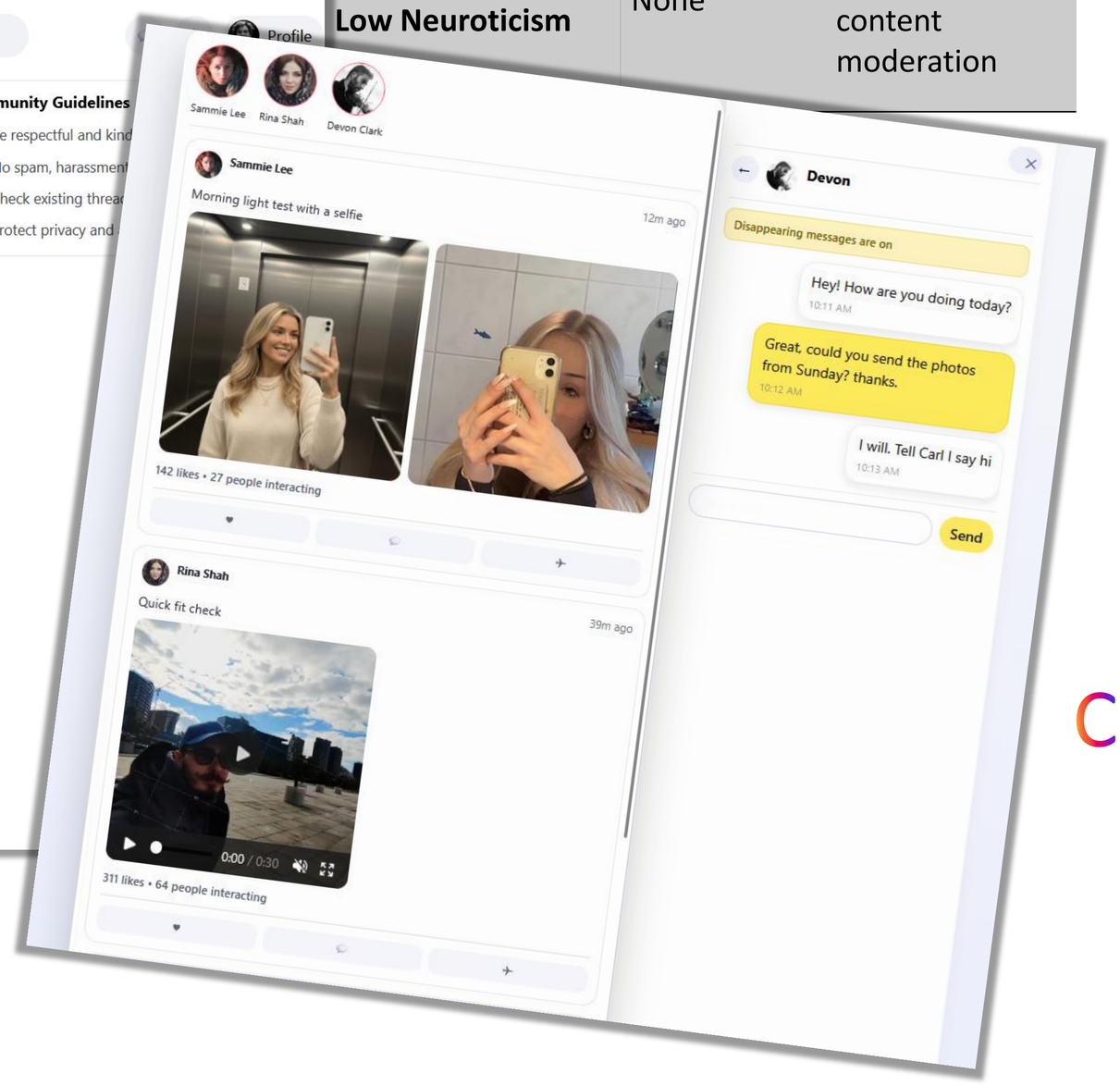
B



A



C



Questionnaire findings here

University of BRISTOL

References

[1] Market Biz, *Social Media Statistics by Marketing Strategy and Facts (2025)*, July 2024. (accessed Mar. 2026).
[2] Market Biz, *Social Media User Statistics (2026)*, 2025. (accessed Mar. 2026).
[3] Alves, T., Natálio, J., Henriques-Calado, J., & Gama, S., "Incorporating personality in user interface design: A review," *Personality and Individual Differences*, vol. 155, Art. 109709, Mar. 2020, doi: 10.1016/j.paid.2019.109709